

[Project title]

Project Report Submitted

To

Dr. D. Y. Patil Vidyapeeth, Centre For Online Learning, Pune



In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirement for the Award of the Degree of

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

BY

[Student Name]

[ERP ID]

[PRN No.]

Name of the internal Supervisor

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[Qualification]

Dr. D. Y. Patil Vidyapeeth, Centre For Online Learning, Pune.

20xx-20xx

Declaration

I, the undersigned, hereby declare that the Project Report entitled “[Title]”, submitted by me to **Dr. D. Y. Patil Vidyapeeth, Centre for Online Learning, Pimpri, Pune**, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of **Master of Business Administration (MBA)**, is my original work.

The conclusions and findings presented in this report are based on the information and resources collected from reliable sources and compiled by me. This work has not been submitted to any other University or Institution for the award of any degree, diploma, or fellowship.

Place: Pune

[Student Name]

[Submitted Date]

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Project Report entitled “[Title]”, which is being submitted herewith for the award of **Master of Business Administration (MBA)** of **Dr. D. Y. Patil Vidyapeeth, Centre for Online Learning, Pimpri, Pune**, is the result of the original research work carried out by **Dr./Mr./Ms. [Full Name]** having **[PRN No.]** under my supervision.

To the best of my knowledge, the Project Report submitted by the student is in accordance with the guidelines prescribed by the Institute and the University.

Internal Supervisor

[**Name**]

Accepted [Date]

Director DPU COL

[**Name**]

Date:

Organization Letter Head

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that [STUDENT NAME] has successfully completed an internship/training as part of the academic requirements for the **MBA Program (Online)** at our organization.

During this period, he/she was found to be sincere, diligent, and hardworking in carrying out the assigned tasks and responsibilities.

We wish him/her continued success in all future endeavours.

Authorized Signatory

[Name]

Seal/Stamp

[Date]

Note: This certificate is optional if not engaged in internship/training at any organization.

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Place: Pune

[Student Name]

[Submitted Date]

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviations	Descriptions
MBA	Master in Business Administration
ISMS	International School of Management Studies
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
APEDA	Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority
DGFT	Directorate General of Foreign Trade
HS	Harmonized System Code
MPEDA	Marine Products Export Development Authority
EIC	Export Inspection Council
EIA	Export Inspection Agency
FSSAI	Food Safety and Standards Authority of India
GAP	Good Agricultural Practices
HACCP	Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
NPOP	National Programme for Organic Production
AGMARK	Agricultural Marketing (Standard Certification System)
RCMC	Registration-Cum-Membership Certificate
ITC	International Trade Centre
WTO	World Trade Organization
UN	United Nations
IEC	Import Export Code
PMKSY	Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana
MIDH	Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture
RKVY	Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana
KVK	Krishi Vigyan Kendra
FPO	Farmer Producer Organization
ie.	That is (id est)
e.g.	For example (exempli gratia)
etc.	And so on (et cetera)
No.	Number
Sr. No.	Serial Number
%	Percentage
₹	Indian Rupee

ABSTRACT

“STUDY ON FARMERS AWARENESS ABOUT EXPORT STANDARDS AND REQUIREMENTS OF HIGH-DEMAND AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS FOR EXPORT”

By

[Name of student]

MBA Sem IV []

Project Supervisor : [-----]

Specializations: [-----]

This study critically explores India's potential in agricultural exports by addressing three core objectives: identifying high-demand agricultural products for export, understanding export quality standards and certification requirements, and evaluating farmers' awareness and willingness to engage in export activities. Through secondary data analysis from credible sources like DGFT, APEDA, Trademap, and FAO, it was found that India is a major exporter of both non-processed and processed Agri-products. Non-processed commodities such as rice (₹73,27,886 lakh), spices (₹7,30,239 lakh), and pulses (₹5,05,952 lakh) dominate exports, while processed products like sugar (₹12,08,480 lakh), vegetable oils (₹7,57,447 lakh), and biscuits (₹3,91,492 lakh) show strong global demand. Major importing countries include the USA, UAE, Germany, and China, indicating favourable trade prospects for Indian agriculture.

The study's second objective focused on export certification and quality standards. Export success is increasingly dependent on compliance with global protocols such as GAP, HACCP, ISO 22000, FSSAI Export NOC, and Organic Certification under NPOP. However, challenges such as high certification costs, lack of documentation knowledge, and insufficient infrastructure pose hurdles for small and medium farmers. These gaps were validated in the third objective through a primary survey of 118 farmers from Satara district. The data showed that 68.6% of farmers had no knowledge of essential export certifications, and only 9.3% had complete understanding of export procedures. Despite this, 78% expressed interest in future exports, indicating a strong intent among farmers if support systems are improved.

The research concludes that while global markets offer immense opportunities for Indian farmers, systematic efforts in training, financial support, certification access, and government outreach are crucial. Strengthening Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs), promoting digital export platforms, and simplifying procedures can transform India's agricultural sector into a globally competitive, export-driven ecosystem.

Keywords: *Agricultural Exports, High-Demand Products, Export Quality Standards, Farmer Awareness, Export Certifications (GAP, HACCP, FSSAI, ISO), Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs)*

Sample Project Report

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

Agriculture plays a vital role in the economic development of many nations, particularly those with strong agrarian sectors. Despite growing global demand for agricultural goods, many farmers remain unable to access international markets due to insufficient knowledge of export standards, certifications, and buyer requirements. This disconnect limits their ability to compete globally and capitalize on high-value opportunities. The core challenge lies in the lack of awareness regarding international quality benchmarks, certification processes, and evolving market preferences, often resulting in non-compliance, shipment rejections, and financial losses. Addressing this gap requires a systematic examination of in-demand agricultural products, an analysis of export regulations, and an assessment of farmers' preparedness to meet global trade standards. Furthermore, strengthening the role of agricultural cooperatives and industry associations can bridge the knowledge gap, offering collective bargaining power and structured training programs.

This research is anchored in key economic and developmental theories, including the Theory of Comparative Advantage, which supports the identification of high-potential export crops, and the Diffusion of Innovations Theory, which helps explain how knowledge of export standards spreads within farming communities. By integrating these frameworks, the study aims to provide actionable insights into how agricultural producers can align their output with global market demands while adhering to necessary regulations. A special focus is placed on digital solutions and e-commerce platforms that can streamline farmers' access to international buyers, reducing dependency on traditional intermediaries.

The findings of this study will hold substantial value for multiple stakeholders. Farmers stand to benefit from a clearer understanding of export opportunities and compliance measures, enabling them to adjust production practices for higher profitability. Policymakers and government agencies can leverage the research to develop targeted training programs, certification support initiatives, and export promotion policies. Additionally, agribusinesses and exporters will gain a deeper understanding of supply chain challenges, facilitating better collaboration with local producers. On a broader scale, enhancing agricultural export readiness can drive

economic growth, increase foreign exchange earnings, and strengthen the competitiveness of the sector. The successful implementation of these measures can lead to greater rural development, improved farmer incomes, and enhanced food security through more sustainable agricultural practices.

Company Profile

Industry: Agribusiness | Organic Farming | Export-Import
| Food Processing | Agri-Tourism

Legal Structure: Limited Liability Partnership (LLP)

Stage: Emerging Startup

Location: Pune, Maharashtra, India

Group Entity: Citroen Agro Farm & Tourism (A Venture of Shabaka Agrimanufex LLP)

About the Company

It is a visionary agribusiness startup that combines sustainable farming, modern food processing, global trade, and rural tourism into a single growth-driven platform. Established with the mission to revolutionize India's agri-value chain, Shabaka is rooted in organic practices, driven by innovation, and powered by rural development.

We are proudly managing over 90 acres of consolidated farmland in Ahmednagar and Solapur districts of Maharashtra, cultivating high-demand crops such as Pomegranate (Bhagwan), Banana (G9), and Moringa. Our farms are in the process of organic certification and serve as a foundation for our integrated value-added product line and export offerings.

In line with our vision of connecting urban consumers with rural experiences, Shabaka also operates Citroen Agro Farm & Tourism, a unique destination promoting Agri-tourism, farm education, and wellness-based rural experiences.

Vision Statement

- To become a new-generation global agribusiness brand known for clean farming, sustainable food innovation, and immersive rural tourism.

Mission Statement

- Promote environmentally conscious, organic farming that boosts soil health and farmer incomes.
- Deliver global-standard dehydrated food products that preserve natural taste and nutrition.
- Build international trade channels for Indian Agri-produce and value-added exports.
- Offer rural tourism experiences that connect people to nature, wellness, and agriculture.
- Uplift rural communities through employment, skill-building, and farm-based entrepreneurship.

Core Ventures

Agriculture & Organic Farming

- 90 acres under cultivation in Ahmednagar & Solapur
- Key crops: Pomegranate, Banana, Moringa
- Transitioning to fully certified organic production
- Practices: Drip irrigation, crop rotation, natural composting

Food Processing

- Dehydrated fruits, vegetables, herbs & powders
- Planned units: solar dryers, freeze-drying, packaging lab
- Products: Banana chips, Moringa powder, dried pomegranate, lemon powder, etc.

Exports & Imports

- Target markets: Middle East, Europe, Southeast Asia
- Export portfolio: Dehydrated foods, spices, herbal powders
- Import interests: Agri-tools, packaging materials, nutrients

Citroen Agro Farm & Tourism

- A rural getaway that blends nature, farming & wellness
- Attractions: Farm stays, fruit picking, rural sports and Physical activities, rural cuisine
- Educational programs: Farm tours, composting demos, school visits

Sustainability & Impact Goals

- 100% renewable energy-powered processing units by 2028
- Training 1,000+ farmers in organic/regenerative farming
- Achieve zero-waste production through upcycling of farm waste
- Employ 100+ locals from nearby villages by 2030
- Host 10,000+ tourists through Citroen Agro Farm & Tourism

Gist of LLP.

- Farm-to-Fork Control
- Export-Focused Agri Processing Rural Development Driven
- Nature-Based Tourism & Learning Strong Leadership with Vision

Connect with Us

- **Farms:** Ahmednagar & Solapur, Maharashtra
- **Registered office:** 104 SY Ultimate, Kondhwa, Pune 411048

CHAPTER II

Objective, Scope, and Purpose of Study

Objectives:

1.2.1 To identify high-demand Agricultural Products for Export

The first objective focuses on analysing global market trends to determine which agricultural commodities and processed foods have the strongest export potential. By examining trade data, consumer preferences, and emerging market opportunities, this research will highlight the most profitable products that farmers can prioritize for international trade.

1.2.2 To understand Export Quality Standards and Certification Requirements

The second objective involves a detailed review of international export regulations, including food safety standards (e.g., Global GAP, HACCP), organic certifications (e.g., USDA Organic, EU Organic), and regional import requirements. Understanding these benchmarks is crucial for farmers to meet buyer expectations and avoid costly compliance failures.

1.2.3 To study Farmers Awareness of Export Standards and willingness for the same

The objective of this study is to assess farmers' awareness of export standards and their willingness to comply with them. It aims to measure the level of knowledge among farmers regarding export procedures, documentation, and quality control measures. Through surveys and interviews, the study will identify gaps in awareness and analyse the factors influencing farmers' willingness to adopt export standards. Based on the findings, recommendations will be provided to enhance farmers' preparedness and participation in the global market.

Scope of the Study

- Focuses on identifying high-demand agricultural products and processed foods with strong export potential.

- Analyses global market trends, trade data, and consumer preferences to determine profitable export commodities.
- Reviews international export quality standards such as Global GAP, HACCP, USDA Organic, and EU Organic certifications.
- Examines regional import regulations and buyer requirements for agricultural products.
- Assesses farmers' awareness of export procedures, documentation, and quality-control measures.
- Evaluates farmers' willingness to comply with export standards and certification requirements.
- Uses surveys, interviews, and field observations to assess knowledge gaps and challenges among farmers.

Purpose of the Study

- To provide clear insights on profitable agricultural commodities suitable for export.
- To help farmers and stakeholders understand mandatory export standards and certification processes.
- To identify gaps in farmers' knowledge regarding export regulations and requirements.
- To determine factors influencing farmers' willingness to adopt quality standards.
- To support policymakers, extension agencies, and agribusinesses in designing effective export-readiness programs.
- To contribute to strategies that improve the overall competitiveness of the agricultural export sector.

Importance of the Study

- Agricultural exports significantly contribute to national income, rural development, and employment generation.

- Identifying profitable export products helps farmers diversify their income and reduce market risks.
- Understanding global quality standards prevents product rejection and increases market acceptance.
- Enhances farmers' ability to access premium international markets and earn higher prices.
- Supports government goals of strengthening the agricultural value chain and boosting export performance.

Need for the Study

- Many farmers lack awareness of international export standards and certification requirements.
- There is a growing global demand for safe, high-quality, and sustainably produced agricultural products.
- Farmers face challenges in meeting complex regulatory and documentation requirements for export.
- Capacity-building programs and policy interventions require data-driven insights, which this study provides.
- Strengthening farmers' export readiness is crucial for improving competitiveness in the global market.
- Helps bridge the gap between available export opportunities and farmers' actual participation in international trade.

CHAPTER III

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Agricultural exports play a crucial role in economic development, particularly in emerging economies where agriculture forms a significant portion of GDP and employment. The global agricultural trade landscape is evolving due to changing consumer preferences, trade agreements, and regulatory standards. Farmers and agribusinesses aiming to expand their market reach must adapt to these dynamic conditions by identifying high-demand products, complying with export quality standards, and enhancing their awareness of export procedures. Several studies have analysed these aspects, highlighting both opportunities and challenges for agricultural exporters.

This review of literature is structured around three key objectives:

- 1) Identifying high-demand agricultural products for export,
- 2) Understanding export quality standards and certification requirements,
- 3) Studying Farmers' Awareness of Export Standards and Willingness for the same.

By reviewing previous research, this study aims to provide insights into the factors influencing agricultural exports and the measures required to improve global market participation for farmers.

Identifying High-Demand Agricultural Products for Export

Smith et al. (2022) explained that trade agreements and reduced export taxes are very helpful for developing countries. These agreements make it easier to sell farm products in global markets. When farmers follow international quality rules, they can reach more customers and earn better prices for their products.

FAO (2021) mentioned that countries with strong farming systems can take more advantage of the increasing global demand for food. To grow in export markets, countries should improve things like cold storage, better packaging, and food processing. These steps help in keeping the food fresh and adding value before it is exported.

APEDA (2021) (<https://apeda.gov.in>) shared that India exports a large number of processed foods, spices, and organic items. These products now make up a big portion of India's agricultural exports. The government supports this through export incentives, training programs, and help with certifications. Also, digital tools and online

platforms are allowing farmers and businesses to directly connect with international buyers, reducing the need for middlemen and increasing profit.

FAO (2021) also noted that climate change is now affecting the production of many export crops. Uncertain whether makes it harder to plan farming and supply exports. Because of this, it is important to promote climate-smart farming. Farmers should grow crops that can survive in difficult weather. For more support and information on export rules, licensing, and government schemes, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) website (<https://dgft.gov.in>) is a very helpful source for farmers and exporters.

Understanding Export Quality Standards and Certification Requirements

Codex Alimentarius Commission (2021) said that following international food safety and quality rules like Global GAP, HACCP, and ISO 22000 is very important. These standards help make sure that food is safe and good in quality for people all over the world. When countries follow these rules, it helps protect consumers and builds trust in global markets.

Bhattacharya & Mehta (2020) explained that developing countries often find it difficult to follow such standards. Many farmers don't know enough about them, and the infrastructure—like testing labs, storage, and training—is not always good. This makes it harder for them to enter export markets.

Gupta & Sen (2019) pointed out that small farmers especially face problems in getting certifications. The process is costly and needs a lot of documents, which they may not understand easily. Because of this, they sometimes avoid exports or cannot compete with bigger exporters.

Jain & Kumar (2022) also said that international standards are not always the same. For example, if a product is certified as USDA Organic, it may still need another certification to be sold in Europe. This creates confusion and adds extra costs and delays. To help farmers, governments should give proper training and support so they can understand and meet different global standards.

Farmers' Awareness of Export Standards and Willingness for the same

Reddy et al. (2020) found that many farmers in developing countries are interested in exporting their produce to international markets. However, most of them do not have enough information about the export process. They are not fully aware of certification systems, food safety rules, and international quality standards. This lack of knowledge becomes a big barrier for them to enter global markets confidently.

Patil & Deshmukh (2021) stated that farmers are more willing to follow export rules when they receive financial incentives, proper training, and easy access to export channels. Many farmers find the export process expensive and complicated, so they avoid it. But if they are supported with training programs and guidance, they can participate more actively in export trade.

Jain & Kumar (2022) explained that cooperatives and farmer-producer organizations (FPOs) are very important in this process. These groups help small farmers by giving them information, organizing training sessions, and helping with paperwork and certification. FPOs also make it easier for farmers to work together and sell in bulk, which is often needed for export.

Gupta & Sen (2019) noted that smallholder farmers often feel scared or unsure about export rules. The process seems costly and difficult to understand. Because of this, many farmers prefer to sell in local markets where there are fewer rules. To change this, the government should create simple certification systems and give financial help or subsidies. This would motivate more farmers to take part in international trade.

CHAPTER IV

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter deals with the methodology followed in conducting the study on high-demand agricultural products for export and farmers' awareness of export standards and requirements. The study was designed to provide valuable insights into the global demand for agricultural products and processed foods, ensuring that farmers and stakeholders understand the critical aspects of quality standards and export certifications.

To achieve the objectives, a systematic approach was adopted that included extensive data collection, qualitative and quantitative analysis, and evaluation of farmers' awareness regarding export regulations. The research methodology involved gathering primary and secondary data through surveys, interviews, and reviews of existing literature on global market trends and export standards. Secondary data was gathered from sources such as the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) and the Trademap website to analyse export trends, market demand, and key trading partners. Furthermore, discussions with key industry experts and government officials were conducted to gain deeper insights into the challenges and opportunities in agricultural exports.

A structured questionnaire was prepared to assess farmers' knowledge of export standards and their compliance with certification requirements. The responses were analysed using statistical tools to determine the awareness level and identify gaps in understanding. Additionally, case studies of successful agricultural exports were examined to provide practical perspectives on effective strategies for meeting global market demands.

The details of the methodology used in the present study are described under the following broad headings:

- 3.1 To identify high-demand Agricultural Products for Export
- 3.2 To understand Export Quality Standards and Certification Requirements
- 3.3 To study Farmers Awareness of Export Standards and willingness for the same.

Identify high-demand Agricultural Products for Export.

To determine the most in-demand agricultural products and processed foods globally, a structured approach based on secondary data sources, trade analytics, and

market trends will be adopted. The methodology involves data collection, analysis, and categorization using international trade platforms and relevant government reports.

Data Collection from Secondary Sources:

The study utilized various secondary sources to gather insights into global agricultural trade trends. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) provided valuable information on India's agricultural exports and their demand in international markets. Trademap (International Trade Centre – ITC) was used to analyse global import-export trends and identify country-wise demand for agricultural and processed food products. FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization) reports were referred to for insights into global agricultural production and consumption trends, while WTO & UN Comtrade databases offered comprehensive international trade statistics and commodity flow insights. Additionally, APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority, India) provided data on processed food exports, major destinations, and potential growth markets.

Categorization Based on HS Codes:

The classification of agricultural and processed food products was done based on Harmonized System (HS) Codes, ensuring a structured approach. Products were divided into three categories: Processed Agricultural Products, which included packaged, semi-processed, and ready-to-eat food items; Non-Processed Agricultural Products, consisting of raw commodities such as grains, pulses, and fresh produce; and Organic and Specialty Products, which focused on organic-certified and region-specific commodities with high market potential.

Demand Analysis and Market Trends:

A high-level demand assessment was conducted using Trademap and DGFT data to determine the top-imported agricultural commodities in major global markets. A country-specific import demand analysis was carried out to identify key importing nations and their trade preferences. Growth rate analysis was employed to examine year-over-year trends and assess emerging product demand. To explore trade opportunities, an export-import gap analysis was conducted, which compared domestic supply with global demand, identifying key areas where demand exceeded supply.

Competitive Landscape and Market Access:

The study also examined tariff and non-tariff barriers, including sanitary and phytosanitary measures, to evaluate trade restrictions that could impact market entry.

Additionally, a key players and competitor analysis was performed to identify major exporters and their positioning in the global agricultural trade market.

Data Interpretation and Reporting:

The findings from the study were compiled into a structured report, highlighting top-performing agricultural products, key global markets, and potential trade opportunities. The report also provided strategic recommendations for exporters and agribusiness stakeholders, helping them make informed decisions on market entry and expansion.

To Understand Export Quality Standard and Certification Requirements

To understand export quality standards and certification requirements for Indian agricultural and processed food products, a structured approach was followed using official government sources and relevant data portals.

Data Collection from Government Sources:

The study relied on official Indian government portals and agencies responsible for export quality regulations. The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) provides food safety regulations for domestic and export compliance. The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) oversees quality standards, export certification, and market access requirements for processed food products. The Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) regulates and certifies seafood exports. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) issues export policies, quality control orders, and mandatory certification guidelines. The Export Inspection Council (EIC) of India ensures product conformity with international quality standards through export inspection and certification. The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) defines national quality benchmarks for agricultural products, including voluntary and mandatory certifications.

Identification of Key Export Quality Standards and Certifications:

The study focused on identifying essential quality certifications required for exporting agricultural and processed food products. These include:

- **APEDA Certification:** Mandatory for processed food exports such as fruits, vegetables, meat, and organic products.

- MPEDA Certification: Required for seafood exports to ensure quality and sustainability compliance.
- EIC Certification (Export Inspection Agency - EIA) Approval: Necessary for products requiring pre-shipment inspection, such as dairy, fishery, and organic foods.
- HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) Certification: Ensures food safety management and is essential for exporting to international markets.
- ISO 9001 Certification: Focuses on quality management systems to enhance product consistency and customer satisfaction.
- ISO 22000 Certification: Specifically designed for food safety management to meet global standards.
- FSSAI Export NOC: Required to ensure compliance with Indian food safety regulations before exporting food products.
- Organic Farming Certification: Includes India Organic (NPOP – National Programme for Organic Production) certification under APEDA for organic agricultural products, ensuring compliance with international organic trade standards.
- GAP (Good Agricultural Practices) Certification: Ensures sustainable farming practices, reduces chemical residues, and enhances food safety, making Indian agricultural products more acceptable in global markets.

Certification Requirements and Compliance Process:

The study examined the certification processes required for Indian exporters. APEDA's Registration-cum-Membership Certificate (RCMC) is mandatory for exporting agricultural and processed foods. The EIC certification process was analysed for pre-shipment inspection of products such as seafood, dairy, and organic foods. The HACCP certification process was reviewed to ensure compliance with food safety and hygiene standards. Additionally, ISO 9001 and ISO 22000 certification requirements were studied to evaluate their role in improving food quality and safety for exports. FSSAI Export NOCs were reviewed for labelling, packaging, and residue testing requirements, while AGMARK certification was examined for product quality assurance in commodities such as spices, fruits, and pulses.

Government Data Portals and Trade Analytics:

The study utilized government data portals such as DGFT's Import-Export Code (IEC) database for tracking exporter registration, APEDA's Agri Exchange portal for global trade trends and compliance updates, and MPEDA's trade database for insights into seafood export regulations. The EIC website was referenced for product-wise export certification requirements. Additionally, the India Trade Portal (Indiatrade.gov.in) and the Commerce Ministry's Export Data Portal provided insights into Indian agricultural export performance and regulatory updates.

Data Interpretation and Reporting:

The findings from this study were compiled into a structured report outlining India's export quality standards, certification processes, and compliance measures. The report also provided strategic recommendations for Indian exporters, focusing on streamlining certification procedures and ensuring adherence to government-mandated quality standards for seamless market access.

To Study Farmers' Awareness of Export Standards and willingness for the same

To study farmers' awareness of export standards and their willingness to comply with them, a structured primary data collection approach was followed using a Google Form survey method. The survey aimed to assess farmers' knowledge, perceptions, and challenges regarding export quality standards and certification requirements.

Survey Design and Questionnaire Development:

A comprehensive and well-structured questionnaire was thoughtfully designed, featuring 11 key questions that delve into various critical aspects of agricultural exports. To ensure seamless understanding and accurate responses, the survey was made available in both Marathi (the local language) and English, enabling farmers from diverse backgrounds to participate with ease and confidence. This bilingual approach aimed to eliminate language barriers, enhance engagement, and gather more reliable and insightful data directly from the farming community. For a detailed view of the questionnaire, refer to Annexure-I.

Sample Size and Data Collection:

The target sample size for the survey was 100 farmers, ensuring a diverse representation of different agricultural sectors, including horticulture, grains, pulses, and organic farming. Farmers were selected from different regions to obtain a balanced perspective on export challenges and awareness. The data collection was conducted through Google Forms, ensuring ease of access and convenience for respondents. The data was collected from Satara Taluka, Satara District, Maharashtra. For the field area map of Satara Taluka, refer to Annexure-II.

Data Analysis and Interpretation:

The collected responses were quantitatively analysed using statistical tools to measure farmers' awareness levels, their willingness to adopt export standards, and the key factors influencing their decision-making. Graphs, percentages, and trend analysis were used to interpret the data and identify major gaps in awareness. Qualitative responses were analysed to understand farmers' perceptions and practical difficulties in adopting export standards.

Reporting and Recommendations:

The findings were compiled into a structured report highlighting farmers' awareness levels, willingness to comply with export standards, and key challenges. The report provided policy recommendations for government agencies and agribusiness stakeholders to enhance farmer participation in export-oriented agriculture. It also suggested training programs, financial assistance, and simplified certification processes to bridge the awareness gap.

CHAPTER V

DATA COLLECTION AND ANALYSIS

This chapter presents the data collection and analysis conducted to achieve the study's objectives: identifying high-demand agricultural products for export, understanding export quality standards and certification requirements, and studying Farmers Awareness of Export Standards and willingness for the same. Data collection involved both primary and secondary sources, and the analysis was conducted using appropriate statistical and qualitative methods.

Data Collection

Data for this study was collected from both primary and secondary sources. Secondary data was obtained from government portals, international trade databases, and published research, while primary data was gathered through a structured survey targeting farmers.

Secondary Data Collection

Secondary data sources included the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), which provided insights into India's agricultural exports and international demand trends. Trademap, an International Trade Centre (ITC) database, was used to analyse global import-export trends and demand for agricultural and processed food products. The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) provided reports on global agricultural production, consumption, and trade statistics. Additional trade statistics and market flow analysis were obtained from the WTO and UN Comtrade. APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) provided insights into processed food exports, major markets, and potential growth opportunities.

Primary Data Collection

A structured questionnaire was carefully designed to assess farmers' awareness of export standards and their willingness to comply with them. To ensure effective communication with respondents, the survey was conducted online using Google Forms and included eleven questions in both Marathi and English. The sample consisted of one hundred farmers engaged in various agricultural sectors, including fruit orchard cultivation, floriculture, vegetable production, grain production (such as wheat, sorghum, pearl millet, rice, and all pulses), organic farming, and other agricultural activities. This diverse representation of farming practices provided comprehensive insights into the sector. For the study, Satara Taluka in Satara District, Maharashtra, was

specifically selected as the survey location to gather region-specific insights from farmers.

Data Analysis

The collected data was analysed using statistical and qualitative techniques to draw meaningful insights.

Analysis of High-Demand Agricultural Products for Export

Categorization Based on Agricultural Product Types

Agricultural products were classified into two broad categories:

Non-Processed Agricultural Products:

These include fresh fruits, vegetables, cereals, pulses, oilseeds, coffee, tea, and spices. These products are typically exported in their raw or minimally processed form. Since they do not undergo extensive processing, their export primarily depends on quality, freshness, and compliance with international safety standards. Countries with high demand for non-processed agricultural products include those with limited agricultural production but high consumption needs. The following data is as per the latest Agricultural Export 2024-2025 (Apr-Dec) report on India's non-processed agricultural exports.

High-demand Non-Processed Agricultural Products

HS Code	Commodities Category	Indian Total Export (Rs. Lakh)	Total No. of Products	Most Exported Product	HS Code	Export Value (Rs. Lakh)
07	Edible Vegetables and Certain Roots and Tubers	13,80,025.11	14	Dried Leguminous Vegetables	0713	5,05,952.20
08	Edible Fruit and Nuts; Peel of Citrus Fruit	8,51,759.00	14	Coconuts, Brazil Nuts	0801	2,66,904.08
09	Coffee, Tea, Mate, and Spices	31,80,996.35	10	Pepper of the Genus Piper	0904	7,30,239.70
10	Cereals	74,93,789.58	8	Rice	1006	73,27,886.3
12	Oil Seeds and Oleaginous Fruits; Misc. Grains, Seeds	13,42,700.67	14	Groundnuts, Not Roasted	1202	5,01,302.08
	Total Indian Export-	27,03,84,086.90	-	-	-	-

Processed Agricultural Products:

These include products that undergo value addition through milling, refining, or preservation. Examples include vegetable oils, sugar, cereal-based products, processed fruits and vegetables, dairy products, confectionery, and beverages. The export of processed agricultural goods requires compliance with strict food safety regulations, labelling standards, and packaging requirements. Processed food exports often have a competitive advantage due to longer shelf life, enhanced quality, and higher market value. The following data is as per the latest Agricultural Export 2024-2025 (Apr-Dec) report on India's processed agricultural exports.

High-demand Processed Agricultural Products

HS Code	Commodities Category	Indian Total Export (Rs. Lakh)	Total No. of Products	Most Exported Product	HS Code	Export Value (Rs. Lakh)
11	Products of the Milling Industry; Malt; Starches	4,79,074.02	9	Starches; Inulin Starches	1108	1,75,202.62
15	Animal or Vegetable Fats and Oils	12,31,550.85	20	Other Fixed Vegetable or Micro Oils	1515	7,57,447.86
17	Sugars and Sugar Confectionery	14,46,373.47	4	Cane/Beet Sugar Chemically Pure	1701	12,08,480.14
19	Preparations of Cereals, Flour, Starch, or Milk	5,68,487.19	5	Bread, Pastry, Cakes, Biscuit	1905	3,91,492.37
20	Preparations of Vegetables, Fruit, Nuts	3,75,554.72	9	Fruits, Nuts, and Other Edible Parts	2008	2,50,423.39
21	Miscellaneous Edible Preparations	10,47,108.62	6	Other Food Preparations N.E.S.	2106	5,29,107.24
22	Beverages, Spirits, and Vinegar	2,88,164.81	9	Undenatured Ethyl Alcohol	2208	1,53,196.72
	Total Indian Export-	27,03,84,086.90	-	-	-	-

Demand and Market Trends Analysis

Data from Trademap and DGFT were used to identify the top-imported agricultural commodities in global markets. A country-specific import demand analysis was conducted to determine key importing nations and their trade preferences. Growth rate analysis was used to assess emerging market trends. Export-import gap analysis helped identify potential export opportunities where demand exceeded domestic supply.

Table 4.3: Top 20 Agricultural Products Importer Countries

Sr. No.	Non-Processed Products	Processed Products
1	United States of America	United States of America
2	China	China
3	Germany	Netherlands
4	Netherlands	Germany
5	United Kingdom	France
6	Spain	Belgium
7	Italy	United Kingdom
8	Viet Nam	Italy
9	Japan	Spain
10	Belgium	Japan
11	United Arab Emirates	Poland
12	Saudi Arabia	Canada
13	Korea, Republic of	Korea, Republic of
14	Mexico	Mexico
15	Indonesia	Saudi Arabia
16	Thailand	United Arab Emirates
17	Türkiye	Australia
18	France	Malaysia
19	Canada	Sweden
20	Russian Federation	Russian Federation

Analysis of Export Quality Standards and Certification Requirements

Identification of Key Export Quality Standards

The study identified certifications necessary for agricultural and processed food exports. Below is an analysis of the primary certifications required for key agricultural commodities:

Primary certifications required for key agricultural commodities

Certification	Applicable Products	Key Compliance Requirements
APEDA Certification	Fruits, vegetables, meat, organic products	Good Agricultural Practices (GAP), pesticide residue limits, export registration.
MPEDA Certification	Seafood, fish products	Quality compliance, cold chain maintenance, hygiene certification.
Export Inspection Council (EIC)	Dairy, fishery, organic food	Pre-shipment inspection, hygiene standards.
HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points)	Processed food, packaged food	Food safety management, hazard analysis.
ISO 9001 & ISO 22000	All food exports	Quality management systems, food safety standards.
FSSAI Export NOC	All agricultural exports	Compliance with domestic food safety norms before exports.
NPOP (National Programme for Organic Production)	Organic food products	Certification for organic food production and processing.
GAP (Good Agricultural Practices)	Fresh produce, vegetables	Sustainability, hygiene, pesticide control.
AGMARK Certification	Grains, pulses, oilseeds, spices	Ensures quality, purity, and adherence to grading standards

Certification Compliance Analysis

To understand how Indian exporters comply with these standards, a sector-wise analysis was conducted. Data from APEDA and MPEDA indicated that compliance levels are high for seafood and processed food exports but relatively low for fresh produce due to the complexity of certification requirements and stringent residue limits set by importing countries. Challenges such as high testing costs, lack of awareness among small-scale farmers, and delays in certification approvals further contribute to lower compliance in the fresh produce sector.

The HACCP certification process was evaluated for food safety compliance, and the role of ISO 9001 and ISO 22000 in quality management for food exports was analysed, emphasizing their importance in maintaining global market credibility. Additionally, FSSAI's export requirements were reviewed, including labelling, packaging, and residue testing, to understand their role in ensuring regulatory compliance. The AGMARK certification process was studied for its role in ensuring product quality assurance in agricultural commodities and enhancing consumer trust in both domestic and international markets.

Analysis of Farmers' Awareness of Export Standards and Willingness for the same. Statistical Analysis of Survey Responses

The awareness level of export standards was measured using frequency analysis. Farmers' willingness to comply with certification requirements was analysed using percentage and trend analysis. Qualitative responses were evaluated to identify challenges faced in adopting export standards.

Key Findings from the Survey

A significant percentage of farmers were unaware of specific export quality standards. Many farmers expressed interest in exporting but lacked knowledge about required certifications. Financial constraints and complex certification processes were identified as major barriers to compliance.

Recommendations for Improving Awareness and Compliance

Government agencies should conduct training programs on export standards and certification procedures. Financial subsidies and incentives should be provided to farmers willing to adopt export compliance measures. Simplification of certification processes should be prioritized to encourage participation in global markets.

CHAPTER VI

Findings and Interpretation

This chapter presents the key findings derived from the data collection and analysis discussed in Chapter 4. These findings are directly aligned with the study's main objectives: identifying high-demand agricultural products for export, understanding export quality standards and certification requirements, and assessing farmers' awareness and willingness to comply with export standards. Based on both primary and secondary data, this chapter interprets trends, gaps, and challenges in India's agricultural export ecosystem and concludes with practical suggestions to improve farmers' participation and compliance in the export market.

Identification of High-Demand Agricultural Products for Export

India's agricultural export landscape has expanded significantly over the last decade, driven by both traditional farming and the growth of the food processing industry. The findings from this study, using credible data from DGFT, APEDA, and ITC Trade Map, indicate that India is a major supplier of both raw and processed agricultural products to the global market. These can be broadly classified into two categories: non-processed (raw) and processed (value-added) agricultural products.

Non-Processed (Raw) Agricultural Products

India's geographic diversity, soil fertility, and climatic variations allow it to grow a wide range of crops that are exported in their raw form. These include cereals, oilseeds, spices, and pulses. Such products are typically preferred by countries where either the climatic conditions do not allow year-round cultivation or where local demand exceeds domestic production. Exporting these products helps India maintain its trade balance and also supports millions of farmers by offering access to global markets.

Raw agricultural exports like basmati and non-basmati rice, spices, and oilseeds continue to dominate the market. Basmati rice is especially popular in Middle Eastern countries for its aroma and grain quality. Groundnuts and legumes find high demand in Southeast Asian countries, while Indian spices have universal appeal due to their unique flavour and therapeutic qualities. The following table provides a summary of India's major non-processed agricultural exports, along with their export values and corresponding top importing countries based on the latest data from the Agricultural Export Report (April–December 2024–2025).

Top 5 Non-Processed Agri Products and their Imported Countries

Sr. No.	HS Code	Commodities Category	Export Value (₹ lakh)	Major Importing Countries
1	1006	Cereals (Rice)	₹73,27,886.30	Saudi Arabia, United Arab Emirates
2	0904	Coffee, Tea, Mate, and Spices – Pepper of the Genus Piper	₹7,30,239.70	United States of America, Germany
3	0713	Edible Vegetables – Dried Leguminous Vegetables	₹5,05,952.20	United Arab Emirates
4	1202	Oil Seeds – Groundnuts (Not Roasted)	₹5,01,302.08	Russian Federation, Malaysia
5	0801	Edible Fruits and Nuts – Coconuts, Brazil Nuts	₹2,66,904.08	Netherlands, United Arab Emirates

Processed (Value-Added) Agricultural Products

In addition to raw agricultural exports, India has shown remarkable growth in the export of processed agricultural products, driven by the rapid development of its food processing industry. These value-added products undergo multiple stages of transformation, including drying, milling, grinding, oil extraction, packaging, and in many cases, conversion into ready-to-eat or ready-to-cook formats. Such processing not only enhances product shelf life and safety but also meets international quality and hygiene standards, making Indian products more competitive in global markets.

Processed agricultural commodities such as sugar, vegetable oils, bakery items, processed fruits, nuts, and confectionery have seen increasing demand across various countries, particularly in developed nations. Consumers in these regions prefer hygienically packaged, certified, and conveniently consumable food products, which has led to the growing acceptance of Indian brands in retail chains and ethnic food segments. Countries like the United States, United Kingdom, Germany, and others continue to be major buyers of Indian processed foods, owing to the consistency in taste, affordability, and India's reputation for food safety and traditional Flavors.

The following table provides a summary of India's major processed agricultural exports, along with their export values and corresponding top importing countries based on the latest data from the Agricultural Export Report (April–December 2024–2025).

Top 5 Processed Agri Products and their Imported Countries

Sr. No.	HS Code	Commodities Category	Export Value (₹ lakh)	Major Importing Countries
1	1701	Sugars and Sugar Confectionery – Cane/Beet Sugar (Pure Form)	₹12,08,480.14	Indonesia, United Arab Emirates
2	1515	Vegetable Fats and Oils – Fixed Vegetable/Micro Oils	₹7,57,447.86	Bangladesh, Belgium, Canada
3	1905	Cereal Preparations – Biscuits, Bread, Cakes, etc.	₹3,91,492.37	United States of America, United Kingdom, Australia
4	2008	Fruit and Nut Preparations – Processed Vegetables/Fruits/Nuts	₹2,50,423.39	Germany, Netherlands
5	1108	Milling Industry Products – Starches and Inulin	₹1,75,202.62	United States of America, Japan

India's agricultural export sector shows a strong global demand for both non-processed and processed products. Key items like cereals (especially rice), spices, oilseeds, sugar, and bakery goods have recorded high export values. This reflects India's capability in both raw production and value addition through food processing. The presence of well-established supply chains and increasing focus on food quality and safety are helping Indian products succeed in international markets.

Major importers of Indian agricultural goods include countries like the USA, Germany, UK, China, UAE, and Saudi Arabia. These nations have strict standards, which India is increasingly able to meet. To maintain and expand this position, it is important to invest in infrastructure, train farmers and exporters on quality standards, and support the food processing sector. Focusing on high-demand export categories can help increase India's global trade share and improve farmers' income.

Understanding Export Quality Standards and Certification Requirements

The analysis reveals that the success of agricultural exports is highly dependent on compliance with international standards and certification protocols. These

certifications play a crucial role in facilitating entry into premium global markets and minimizing trade rejections. Export certifications are product-specific and require adherence to a range of food safety, quality, traceability, and sustainability standards.

For example, APEDA certification, applicable to exports of fruits, vegetables, and organic produce, mandates Good Agricultural Practices (GAP), strict control on pesticide residues, and product traceability. Similarly, the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) oversees quality and cold chain compliance in seafood exports, while the Export Inspection Council (EIC) conducts pre-shipment inspections for categories like dairy, fishery, and organics.

Processed food exporters are required to follow globally recognized food safety management systems such as HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) and ISO 22000, which focus on identifying critical hazards and implementing preventive controls throughout the supply chain. Additionally, ISO 9001 enhances overall quality management, especially for exporters targeting developed markets such as Europe and North America.

The FSSAI Export NOC is a mandatory compliance requirement that ensures all food products adhere to Indian domestic food safety laws before they are approved for export. For organic products, exporters must obtain NPOP (National Programme for Organic Production) certification, which validates both organic cultivation and post-harvest processing practices.

Despite the established framework, the study found significant disparities in certification awareness and compliance, particularly among smallholder farmers and fresh produce exporters. While large-scale exporters especially in seafood and processed food sectors demonstrated high compliance levels due to better infrastructure and access to professional consultancy services, small-scale producers struggled due to:

- Limited access to testing laboratories for pesticide residues and contaminants.
- High cost of certification procedures and annual audits.
- Lack of knowledge and institutional support to manage documentation and sustainability protocols.
- Inadequate cold storage and transportation infrastructure, especially for perishable goods.

For example, GAP certification, essential for exporting fresh fruits and vegetables, requires producers to maintain detailed records of hygiene practices, pest

control, chemical usage, and sustainability indicators—tasks often unaffordable or unfamiliar to smaller producers. Similarly, AGMARK certification, which plays a vital role in grading and quality assurance for grains, pulses, oilseeds, and spices, was underutilized due to limited awareness and accessibility in rural areas.

Key Export Certifications and Their Compliance Requirements

Certification	Applicable Products	Key Compliance Requirements
APEDA	Fruits, vegetables, organic products	GAP, pesticide residue control, traceability
MPEDA	Seafood and fishery products	Cold chain maintenance, hygiene, export registration
EIC	Dairy, fishery, organic	Pre-shipment inspection, hygiene standards
ISO 9001 & ISO 22000	All food categories	Quality and food safety management
HACCP	Processed and packaged food	Hazard analysis, preventive safety controls
FSSAI Export NOC	All agricultural exports	Domestic food safety compliance
NPOP	Organic food	Organic production and processing certification
GAP	Fresh produce, vegetables	Hygiene, pesticide control, sustainability
AGMARK	Grains, pulses, oilseeds, spices	Grading, purity, quality standards

Study Farmers Awareness of Export Standards and willingness for the same

This section presents the findings based on the primary survey conducted to evaluate farmers' awareness regarding agricultural export standards and their willingness to align with them. Rooted in the methodology outlined in Chapter 3, the study leveraged a bilingual, well-structured Google Form questionnaire designed to capture insights across diverse farming sectors within **Satara Taluka of Maharashtra**. A total of **100** respondents provided valuable data reflecting their understanding,

challenges, and perceptions related to export procedures, certifications, and international quality requirements.

Each question was carefully framed to assess various dimensions of awareness from basic knowledge of export opportunities to familiarity with certifications like APEDA, MPEDA, FSSAI, HACCP, and GAP. The responses offer a clear picture of the existing knowledge gaps and the degree of readiness among farmers to adopt practices aligned with global standards. Furthermore, the study explores their willingness to undergo training, invest in compliance, and seek institutional support critical indicators for developing an export-oriented agri-business ecosystem.

To ensure maximum participation and clarity in responses, the questionnaire was developed in **Marathi**, respecting the local linguistic preference of farmers. The Marathi version of the questionnaire is provided at the end of this chapter in Annexure-I for reference.

The responses are presented and interpreted in a structured manner, using graphical tools, percentages, and descriptive analysis. Each question from the survey has been analysed and interpreted in detail below to derive meaningful insights that support policy formulation and practical interventions.

Question-wise Interpretation in Details

Q.1) Write your full name.

Q.2) Write the name of your village.

Q.3) Write the name of your taluka.

Distribution of Survey Responses by District and Village

District	Taluka/Village	No. of Responses	District	Taluka/Village	No. of Responses
Satara	Karandi	24		Shahapur	3
	Upali	9		Shelakewadi	2
	Parmale	8		Pilani	2
	Zarewadi	7		Other Villages	44
	Kari	7	Sangali	Vita	1
	Asangaon	5	Chh. Sambhajinagar	Kannad	1
	Bhatmarali	4	Kolhapur	Bhudargad	1

				Total	118
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Q.4) What type of farming are you engaged in?

- Fruit orchard cultivation
- Floriculture
- Vegetable production
- Grain production (Wheat, Sorghum, Pearl Millet, Rice, All Pulses, etc.)
- Others (Please specify)



४. आपण कोणत्या प्रकारच्या शेतीत कार्यरत आहात?

118 responses

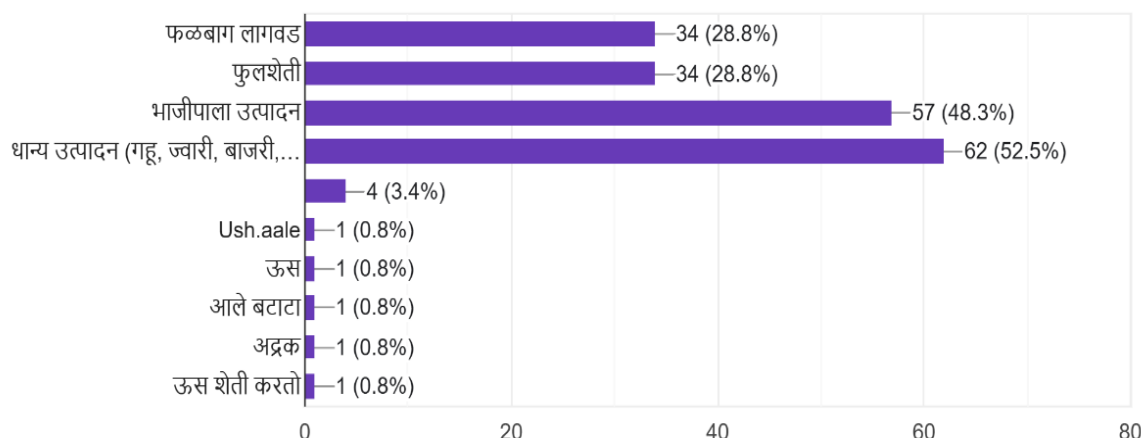


Fig. 5.1: Distribution of Respondents by Type of Farming Activity

Interpretation:

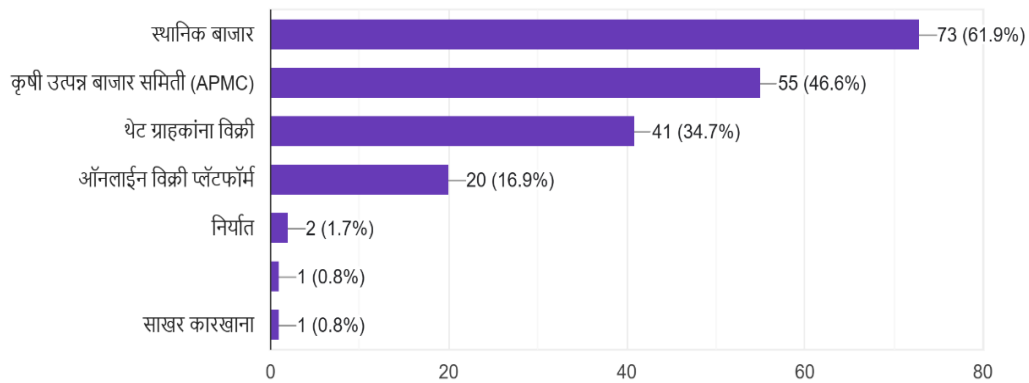
Out of the total 118 responses, the most common type of farming reported is grain production (such as wheat, sorghum, pearl millet, rice, and pulses), with 62 respondents involved, which makes up 52.5%. This is followed by vegetable production, practiced by 57 respondents, accounting for 48.3%. Both fruit orchard cultivation and floriculture were mentioned by 34 respondents each, making up 28.8% of the total. Additionally, 9 respondents (7.4%) reported being involved in other types of farming. These numbers indicate that many farmers are engaged in more than one type of farming, with grain and vegetable production being the most common practices among the 118 participants.

Q.5) Which methods do you use for selling your agricultural produce?

- Local market
- Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC)
- Direct sale to consumers
- Online selling platforms
- Export
- Others (Please specify)

५. आपण आपल्या शेती उत्पादनाच्या विक्रीसाठी कोणते मार्ग अवलंबता?

118 responses



Distribution of Respondents by Methods of Selling Agricultural Produce

Interpretation:

Out of the total 118 responses, the majority of farmers sell their produce through the local market, with 73 respondents, which is 61.9%. 55 farmers (46.6%) use the Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC), while 41 respondents (34.7%) sell their produce directly to consumers. A smaller portion, 20 farmers (16.9%), have started using online selling platforms. Very few respondents, only 2 (1.7%), reported being involved in export, and the same number (2 respondents or 1.7%) mentioned other methods. This clearly shows that export activities are very limited among the surveyed farmers. Most of them rely on local markets and APMC for selling, and very few have access to or are using advanced selling methods like online platforms or export,

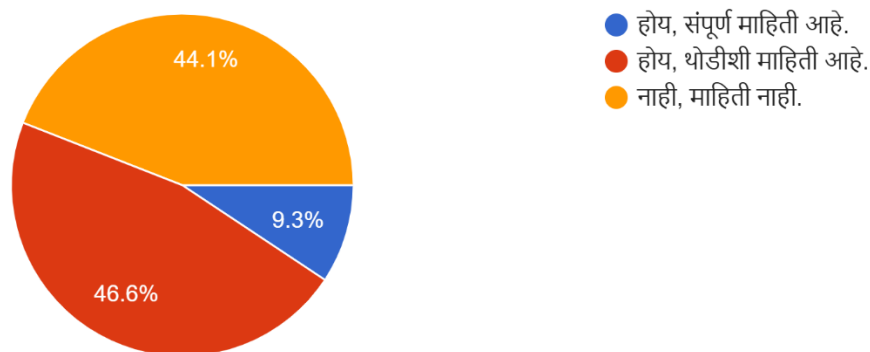
indicating a lack of awareness, infrastructure, or access to export markets among the majority of farmers.

Q.6) Do you have knowledge about the major regulations required for agricultural product exports?

- Yes, I have complete knowledge.
- Yes, I have partial knowledge.
- No, I do not have any knowledge.

६. कृषी उत्पादन निर्यातीसाठी लागणाऱ्या प्रमुख नियमांविषयी तुम्हाला माहिती आहे का?

118 responses



Awareness Level Regarding Export Regulations Among Farmers

Interpretation:

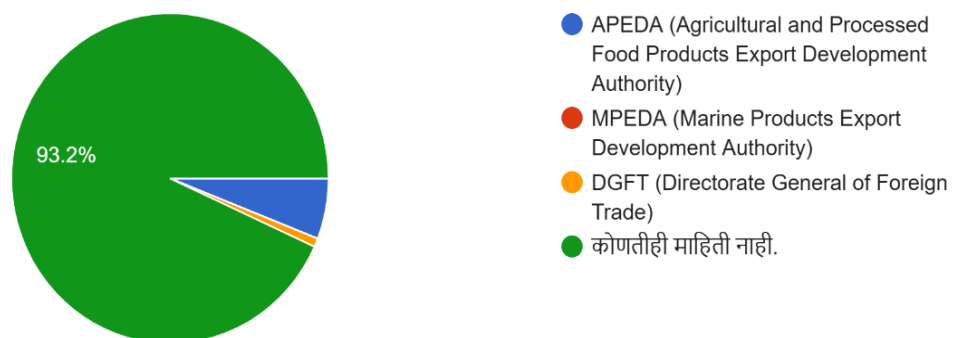
Out of the total 118 respondents, only a small portion 9.3% reported having complete knowledge about the major regulations required for exporting agricultural products. A larger group, 46.6%, said they have partial knowledge, indicating some awareness but not a full understanding. Meanwhile, 44.1% of the farmers admitted that they do not have any knowledge about export regulations. This highlights a significant knowledge gap among farmers regarding the essential rules and procedures for export. Although nearly half are somewhat informed, the overall low percentage of complete awareness suggests the need for targeted training and awareness programs to help farmers explore and benefit from export opportunities.

Q.7) Which of the following export-related organizations do you have information about?

- APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority)
- MPEDA (Marine Products Export Development Authority)
- DGFT (Directorate General of Foreign Trade)
- I have no information.
- Others (Please specify)

७. खालीलपैकी कोणत्या निर्यात संबंधित संस्थांची माहिती आपणास आहे?

118 responses



Respondents Awareness of Export-Related Organizations

Interpretation:

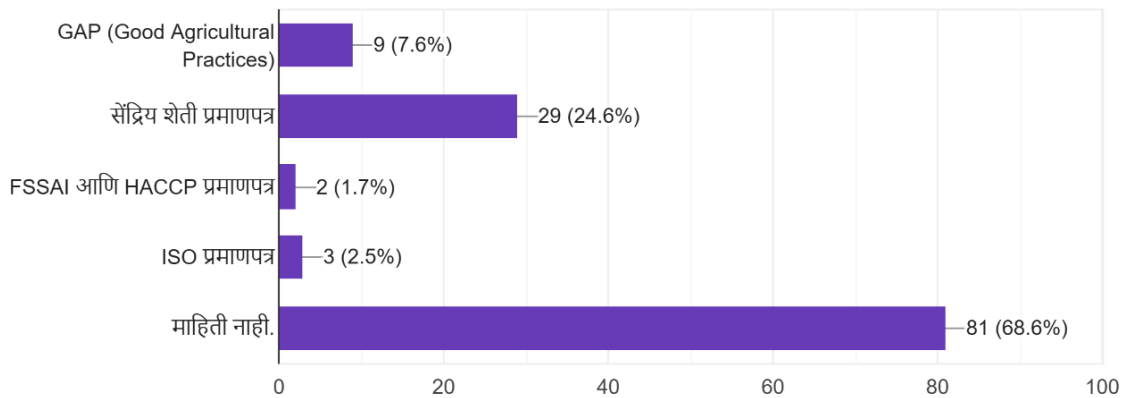
Out of the total 118 respondents, an overwhelming majority 110 farmers (93.2%) reported that they do not have any information about export-related organizations. Only 7 respondents (5.9%) were aware of APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority), and just 1 respondent (0.8%) had heard of DGFT (Directorate General of Foreign Trade). No one reported having information about MPEDA (Marine Products Export Development Authority). This data clearly reflects a critical lack of awareness among farmers regarding the key institutions that support and regulate agricultural exports. The near absence of knowledge about these organizations suggests an urgent need for outreach, education, and support programs to connect farmers with the right export-related resources and opportunities.

Q.8) Do you know which certifications are necessary for ensuring the quality of your products?

- GAP (Good Agricultural Practices)
- Organic Certification
- HACCP Certification
- FSSAI (Food Safety and Standards Authority of India)
- ISO Certification
- No information.

८. आपल्या उत्पादनांच्या गुणवत्तेसाठी खालील कोणते प्रमाणपत्र आवश्यक आहे, याची तुम्हाला माहिती आहे का?

118 responses



Farmers' Knowledge of Essential Quality Certifications

Interpretation:

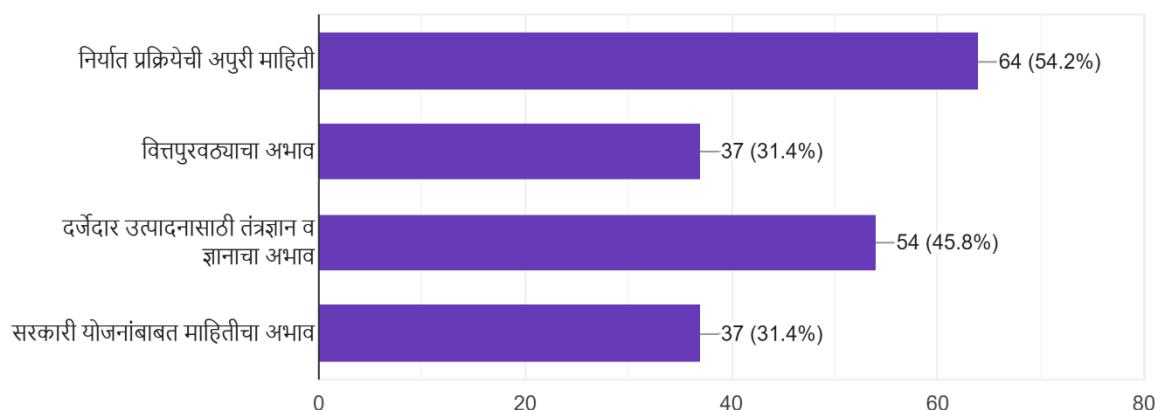
Out of the total 118 respondents, a significant 81 farmers (68.6%) reported that they do not have any information about the certifications required to ensure the quality of agricultural products for export. Only a few respondents were aware of specific certifications: 29 farmers (24.6%) knew about Organic Certification, 9 (7.6%) were familiar with GAP (Good Agricultural Practices), while just 2 (1.7%) and 3 (2.5%) knew about FSSAI & HACCP Certification and ISO Certification, respectively. This data indicates a major awareness gap regarding essential quality standards and certifications, which are crucial for both domestic and international market competitiveness. It highlights the need for capacity-building initiatives to educate farmers about these certifications and help them meet global quality requirements.

Q.9) What are the main reasons why farmers are less involved in exports?

- Lack of knowledge about the export process
- Lack of financial support
- Lack of technology and knowledge for quality production
- Lack of awareness about government schemes
- Others (Please specify)

९. शेतकरी निर्यातीकडे कमी प्रमाणात वळतात, यामागील मुख्य कारणे कोणती आहेत?

118 responses



Major Challenges Faced by Farmers in Entering Export Markets

Interpretation:

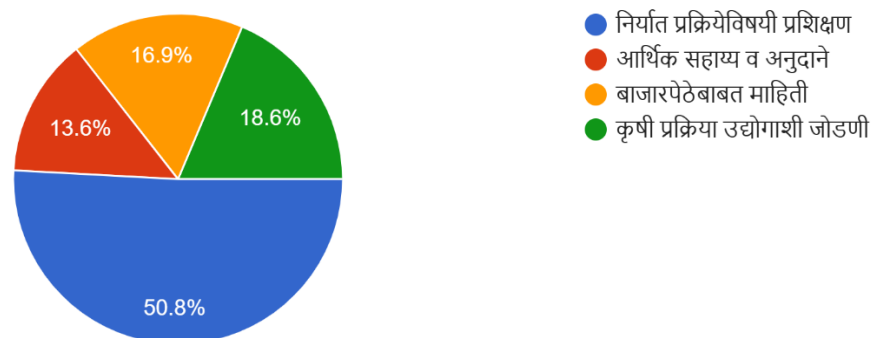
Out of the total 118 respondents, the most common reason farmers cited for being less involved in exports was a lack of knowledge about the export process, reported by 64 farmers (54.2%). Additionally, 54 respondents (45.8%) pointed to a lack of technology and knowledge for quality production, highlighting challenges in meeting export standards. Financial constraints and lack of awareness about government schemes were each mentioned by 37 farmers (31.8%), showing that both monetary support and policy awareness are critical factors. Overall, the data reveals that limited knowledge, inadequate resources, and insufficient support systems are the key barriers preventing farmers from actively participating in agricultural exports. Addressing these issues through training, financial assistance, and awareness programs could significantly improve farmers' involvement in global markets.

Q.10) What facilities or assistance do you think are needed to increase your agricultural exports?

- Training on the export process
- Financial assistance and subsidies
- Market information
- Linkage with agro-processing industries
- Others (Please specify)

१०. आपण आपल्या उत्पादनाची निर्यात वाढविण्यासाठी कोणत्या सुविधा किंवा मदतीची आवश्यकता वाटते?

118 responses



Facilities and Support Expected by Farmers to Boost Exports

Interpretation:

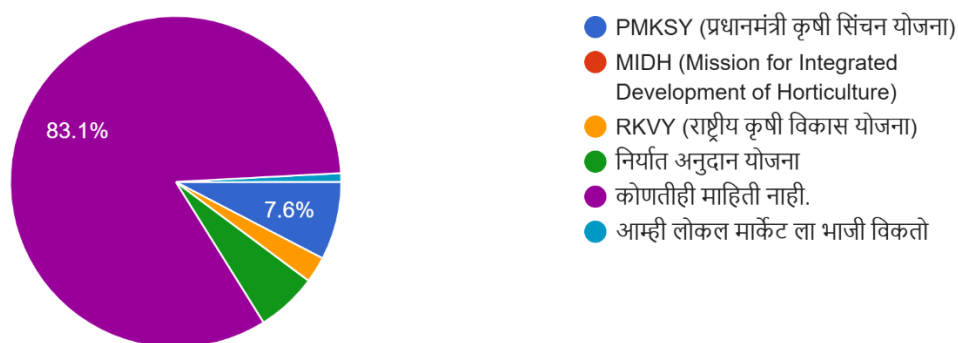
Out of the total 118 respondents, the majority 50.8% stated that they need training on the export process to boost their involvement in agricultural exports. This suggests a strong demand for educational initiatives and capacity-building programs among farmers. Additionally, 18.6% felt that linkages with agro-processing industries would help, while 16.9% mentioned the need for market information to better understand demand and pricing. Only 13.6% of the farmers emphasized the need for financial assistance and subsidies, indicating that while financial support is important, knowledge and industry connections are perceived as more urgent. These insights underline the importance of skill development, access to market data, and strategic partnerships in enabling farmers to access export opportunities more effectively.

Q.11) Which government schemes do you have information about for agricultural exports?

- PMKSY (Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana)
- MIDH (Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture)
- RKVY (Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana)
- Export subsidy schemes
- No information

११. कृषी उत्पादन निर्यातीसाठी कोणत्या शासकीय योजनांची माहिती आपणास आहे?

118 responses



Awareness of Government Schemes Related to Agricultural Exports

Interpretation;

Out of the total 118 respondents, a significant majority 98 farmers (83.1%) reported that they have no information about any government schemes related to agricultural exports. This clearly highlights a major gap in awareness and outreach. Only a small number of farmers were aware of specific schemes: 9 respondents (7.6%) mentioned PMKSY (Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana), 7 respondents (5.9%) knew about export subsidy schemes, and just 3 respondents (2.5%) had heard of RKVY (Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana). Notably, no responses were recorded for MIDH (Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture). This data strongly suggests that government efforts and schemes are not reaching the grassroots level effectively, and there is an urgent need for awareness drives and informational outreach to educate farmers about the support available to them for agricultural exports.

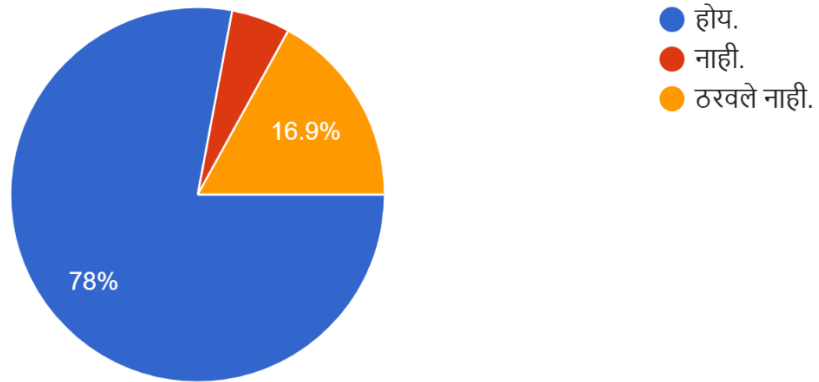
Q.12) Do you plan to make efforts to export your agricultural produce in the future?

- Yes
- No
- Not decided



१२. आपण आपल्या उत्पादनाच्या निर्यातीसाठी भविष्यात प्रयत्न करू इच्छिता का?

118 responses



Farmers Future Intentions Regarding Agricultural Export Participation

Interpretation:

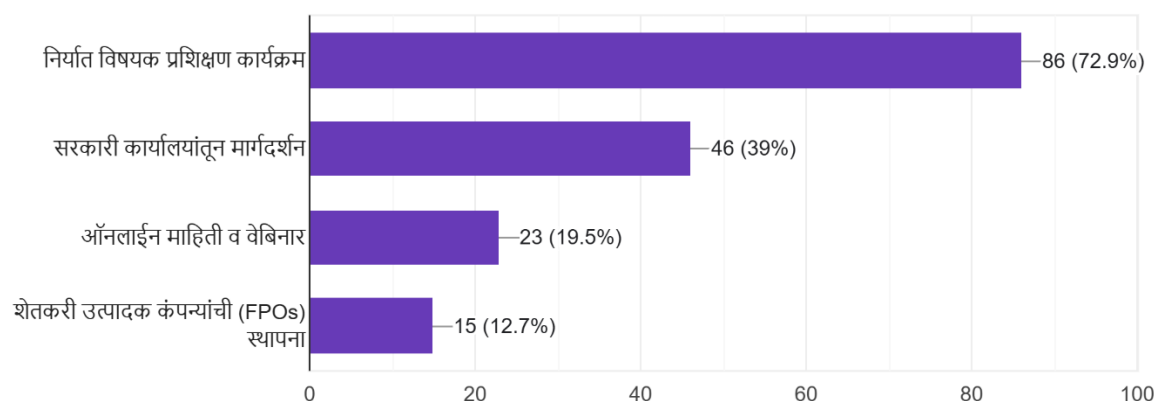
Out of the 118 total respondents, a significant majority 92 farmers (78%) expressed a strong intention to make efforts to export their agricultural produce in the future. This highlights a growing aspiration among farmers to explore international markets and expand their agricultural business beyond domestic boundaries. On the other hand, only 6 respondents (5.1%) stated that they do not have any plans for export, indicating minimal resistance or disinterest. Additionally, 20 farmers (16.9%) mentioned that they are still undecided, which shows that with the right awareness campaigns, training, and government support, even more farmers could be motivated to enter the export space. This overall data reflects a positive outlook and readiness among farmers towards engaging in the export sector if given the proper facilities and guidance.

Q.13) What measures can be taken to increase awareness about agricultural exports among farmers?

- Export-related training programs
- Guidance from government offices
- Online information and webinars
- Establishment of Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs)
- Others (Please specify)

१३. शेतकऱ्यांसाठी निर्यातविषयक जागरूकता वाढवण्यासाठी कोणते उपाय करता येतील?

118 responses



Strategies Recommended by Farmers to Promote Export Awareness

Interpretation:

Out of the total 118 respondents, a large majority 86 farmers (72.9%) believed that export-related training programs would be the most effective way to increase awareness about agricultural exports. This indicates that farmers are eager to learn but need proper guidance and structured educational opportunities. Additionally, 46 respondents (39%) suggested that guidance from government offices could help farmers better understand and access export opportunities, highlighting the need for stronger government outreach.

Moreover, 23 farmers (19.5%) recommended online information and webinars as helpful tools, especially for tech-savvy individuals and the younger generation. Another 15 respondents (12.7%) supported the establishment of Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) as a way to collectively spread awareness and build export capabilities. This data suggests that a combination of hands-on training, digital learning,

government involvement, and farmer group networks can play a key role in increasing farmers' knowledge and participation in agricultural exports.

Key Findings:

The overall findings from the survey indicate a mixed scenario regarding the preparedness of farmers for agricultural exports. While farmers are involved in a variety of farming practices and show active participation in the local and domestic markets, their involvement in export activities remains very limited. A major portion of the respondents lacks awareness of export-related procedures, required certifications, and the roles of key government organizations that facilitate agricultural exports. Furthermore, most farmers are unaware of the government schemes designed to support and encourage agricultural exports. Despite this, a large number of farmers have expressed a willingness to engage in export activities in the future. This shows a growing interest and ambition among farmers to tap into international markets. The responses also highlight certain barriers such as lack of knowledge, financial constraints, and insufficient access to technology for quality production. Overall, the data reflects that while the potential for export is high among farmers, there is a considerable knowledge gap that needs to be addressed to transform this potential into reality.

CHAPTER VII

RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSIONS

Based on the analysis and findings of the study, the following suggestions are proposed to improve awareness, participation, and readiness of farmers for agricultural exports:

- Farmers should be given basic training on export procedures through structured modules in simple and local language formats.
- Regular workshops and awareness programs should be conducted at the village and taluka levels by government departments, Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs), and export facilitation agencies like APEDA and DGFT.
- Export-related documents, guidelines, and scheme details must be translated into regional languages like Marathi for better understanding and implementation by local farmers.
- Financial assistance should be made available to help farmers obtain necessary export certifications such as GAP, Organic Certification, FSSAI, and HACCP.
- Formation and strengthening of Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) is necessary to enable small and marginal farmers to access export markets collectively.
- A dedicated toll-free helpline or help desk should be launched to guide farmers on export-related queries and procedures.
- Farmers should be encouraged and facilitated to participate in national and international Agri-trade fairs to gain market exposure and understand global demand.
- The government should highlight success stories of farmers who have successfully entered export markets, to motivate and inspire others.
- Awareness of government schemes and incentives for exports should be improved through targeted campaigns, SMS services, and local media.
- Practical, hands-on training through model export villages or demo farms should be introduced to provide real-time learning experiences.
- Use of mobile applications, digital platforms, and social media can be leveraged to provide timely updates and export market intelligence to farmers.

- NGOs, private agribusiness firms, and agri-startups should also be involved in capacity building and farmer engagement programs.
- Investment should be made in cold storage facilities, packaging centres, and efficient logistics to reduce post-harvest losses and improve export quality.
- Special programs and incentives should be introduced for young and educated farmers who show interest in entering the agricultural export sector.
- Export Help Centres should be set up at local markets (mandis) so that farmers can get personal help and guidance about the export process, documents, and other formalities.
- Agricultural colleges and universities should start special courses and training that teach students and farmers about export, so they can be more prepared and get the right knowledge.
- Local cooperative societies and rural banks should help spread awareness about government schemes, export subsidies, and low-interest loans that can support farmers in starting exports.

These suggestions aim to bridge the gap between existing potential and actual performance in the export sector, and help build an export-oriented, competitive, and inclusive agricultural ecosystem.

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Annexure – I

Questionnaire Used for Survey

The following questionnaire was used to collect primary data from farmers to understand their cultivation of high-demand agricultural products and their awareness of export standards and requirements. The survey was conducted using **Google Forms**, and responses were collected from farmers in **Satara Taluka, Satara District, Maharashtra**. The questionnaire was prepared in the **English & local language** to ensure better understanding and participation from local farmers.

Marathi	English
१. मूलभूत माहिती - आपले पूर्ण नाव लिहा. - आपल्या गावाचे नाव लिहा. - आपल्या तालुक्याचे नाव लिहा.	1. Basic Information - Write your full name. - Write the name of your village. - Write the name of your taluka.
२. आपण कोणत्या प्रकारच्या शेतीत कार्यरत आहात? - फळबाग लागवड - फुलशेती - भाजीपाला उत्पादन - धान्य उत्पादन (गहू, ज्वारी, बाजरी, भात, सर्व डाळवर्गीय पिके, इत्यादी.) - इतर (कृपया नमूद करा)	2. What type of farming are you engaged in? - Fruit orchard cultivation - Floriculture - Vegetable production - Grain production (Wheat, Sorghum, Pearl Millet, Rice, All Pulses, etc.) - Others (Please specify)
३. आपण आपल्या शेती उत्पादनाच्या विक्रीसाठी कोणते मार्ग अवलंबता? - स्थानिक बाजार - कृषी उत्पन्न बाजार समिती (APMC) - थेट ग्राहकांना विक्री - ऑनलाईन विक्री प्लॅटफॉर्म - निर्यात - इतर (कृपया नमूद करा)	3. Which methods do you use for selling your agricultural produce? - Local market - Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC) - Direct sale to consumers - Online selling platforms - Export - Others (Please specify)
४. कृषी उत्पादन निर्यातीसाठी लागणाऱ्या प्रमुख नियमांविषयी तुम्हाला माहिती आहे का? - होय, संपूर्ण माहिती आहे. - होय, थोडीशी माहिती आहे. - नाही, माहिती नाही.	4. Do you have knowledge about the major regulations required for agricultural product exports? - Yes, I have complete knowledge. - Yes, I have partial knowledge. - No, I do not have any knowledge.
५. आपण खालीलपैकी कोणत्या निर्यातसंबंधित संस्थांची माहिती ठेवता? - APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) - MPEDA (Marine Products Export	5. Which of the following export-related organizations do you have information about? APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority)

- Development Authority) ○ DGFT (Directorate General of Foreign Trade) ○ अन्य (कृपया नमूद करा) ○ कोणतीही माहिती नाही	○ MPEDA (Marine Products Export Development Authority) ○ DGFT (Directorate General of Foreign Trade) ○ Others (Please specify) ○ I have no information.
६. आपल्या उत्पादनांच्या गुणवत्तेसाठी खालील कोणते प्रमाणपत्र आवश्यक आहे याची तुम्हाला माहिती आहे का? ■ GAP (Good Agricultural Practices) ■ सेंद्रिय शेती ■ HACCP प्रमाणपत्र ■ FSSAI (Food Safety and Standards Authority of India) ■ ISO प्रमाणपत्र ■ माहिती नाही.	6. Do you know which certifications are necessary for ensuring the quality of your products? ■ GAP (Good Agricultural Practices) ■ Organic Certification ■ HACCP Certification ■ FSSAI (Food Safety and Standards Authority of India) ■ ISO Certification ■ No information.
७. शेतकरी निर्यातीकडे कमी प्रमाणात वळतात, यामागील मुख्य कारणे कोणती आहेत? ■ निर्यात प्रक्रियेची अपुरी माहिती ■ वित्तपुरवठ्याचा अभाव ■ दर्जेदार उत्पादनासाठी तंत्रज्ञान व ज्ञानाचा अभाव ■ सरकारी योजनांबाबत माहितीचा अभाव ■ इतर (कृपया नमूद करा)	7. What are the main reasons why farmers are less involved in exports? ■ Lack of knowledge about the export process ■ Lack of financial support ■ Lack of technology and knowledge for quality production ■ Lack of awareness about government schemes ■ Others (Please specify)
८. आपण आपल्या उत्पादनाची निर्यात वाढविण्यासाठी कोणत्या सुविधा किंवा मदतीची आवश्यकता वाटते? ○ निर्यात प्रक्रियेविषयी प्रशिक्षण ○ आर्थिक सहाय्य व अनुदाने ○ बाजारपेठेबाबत माहिती ○ कृषी प्रक्रिया उद्योगाशी जोडणी ○ इतर (कृपया नमूद करा)	8. What facilities or assistance do you think are needed to increase your agricultural exports? ○ Training on the export process ○ Financial assistance and subsidies ○ Market information ○ Linkage with agro-processing industries ○ Others (Please specify)
९. आपण कृषी उत्पादन निर्यातीसाठी कोणत्या शासकीय योजनांची माहिती ठेवता? ○ PMKSY (प्रधानमंत्री कृषी सिंचन योजना) ○ MIDH (Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture) ○ RKVY (राष्ट्रीय कृषी विकास योजना) ○ निर्यात अनुदान योजना ○ कोणतीही माहिती नाही.	9. Which government schemes do you have information about for agricultural exports? ○ PMKSY (Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana) ○ MIDH (Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture) ○ RKVY (Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana) ○ Export subsidy schemes ○ No information
१०. आपण आपल्या उत्पादनाच्या निर्यातीसाठी	10. Do you plan to make efforts to export your agricultural produce in the future?

भविष्यात प्रयत्न करू इच्छिता का? ○ होय. ○ नाही. ○ ठरवले नाही.	○ Yes ○ No ○ Not decided
११. शेतकऱ्यांसाठी निर्यातविषयक जागरूकता वाढवण्यासाठी कोणते उपाय करता येतील? ▪ निर्यात विषयक प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम ▪ सरकारी कार्यालयांतून मार्गदर्शन ▪ ऑनलाईन माहिती व वेबिनार ▪ शेतकरी उत्पादक कंपन्यांची (FPOs) स्थापना ▪ इतर (कृपया नमूद करा)	11. What measures can be taken to increase awareness about agricultural exports among farmers? ▪ Export-related training programs ▪ Guidance from government offices ▪ Online information and webinars ▪ Establishment of Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) ▪ Others (Please specify)

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Sample Project Report

Annexure – II

Field Map of Survey Area

The field survey for this study was conducted in various villages of Satara Taluka, Satara District, Maharashtra. The map below provides a visual representation of the geographical coverage of the survey. It highlights the region where farmers were approached for collecting primary data using Google Forms.

Survey Region: Satara Taluka

District: Satara

State: Maharashtra

Field Map:

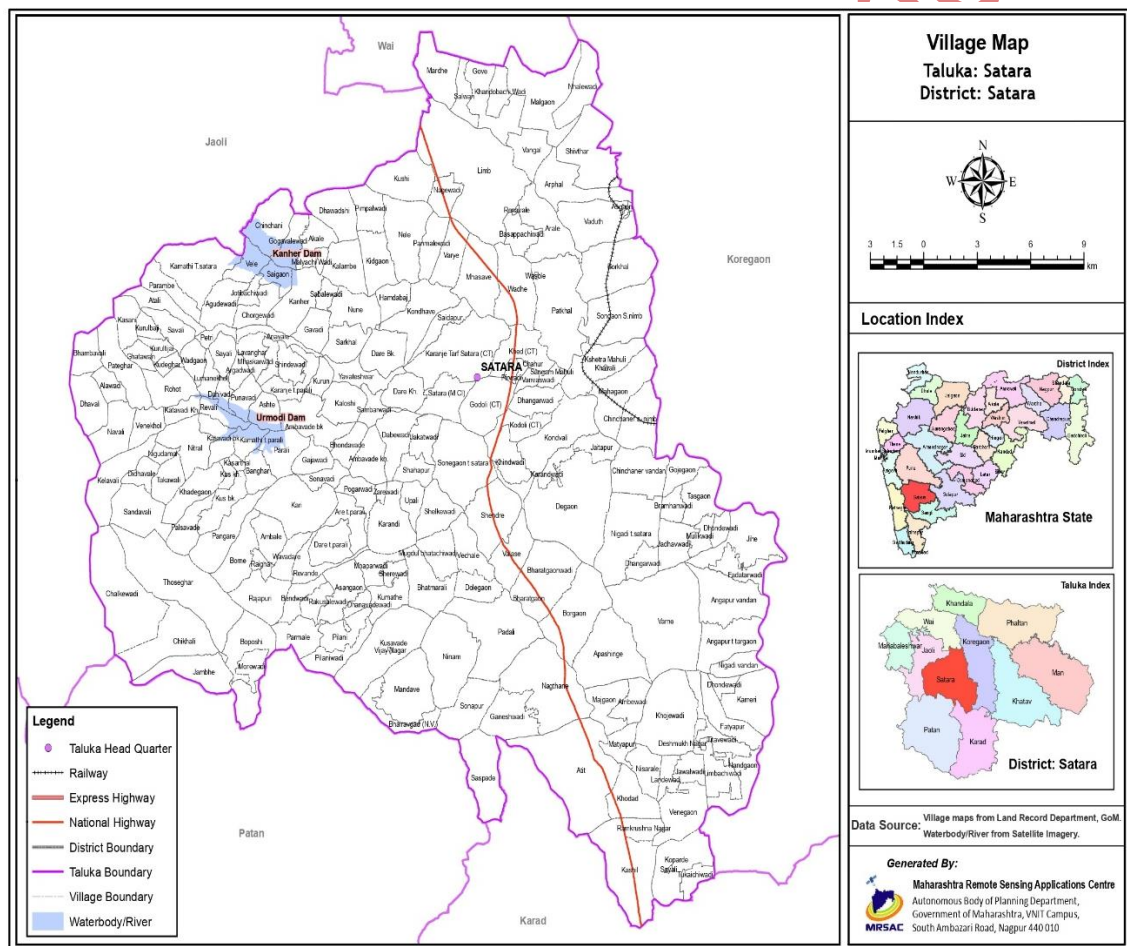


Fig A2.1: Field Map of Satara Taluka

Source: https://mrsac.gov.in/write-readdata/MRSAC/map/15674912385d6e04a6a29dcTH_STR_Satara.pdf